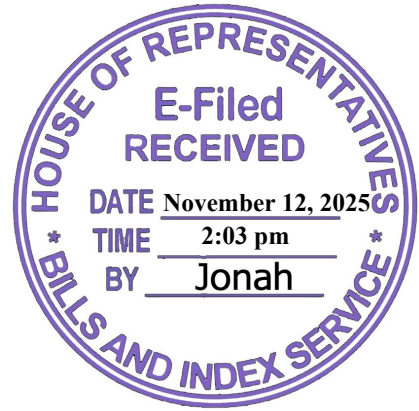


Republic of the Philippines
House of Representatives
Quezon City, Metro Manila

TWENTIETH CONGRESS
First Regular Session

HOUSE BILL NO. 5912



Introduced by Hon. Florabel Co Yatco

EXPLANATORY NOTE

A housewife's life does not stop within the four corners of her home. With the right opportunities and meaningful training, what we once saw as simply a homemaker can become a source of income and a valuable contributor to our country's digital economy.

In an era defined by rapid digital transformation and the rise of artificial intelligence (AI), the global demand for digitally skilled workers continues to grow. Among the most accessible and scalable pathways to digital employment is data annotation—a foundational component of AI development that involves labeling data used to train machine learning models. This labor-intensive process presents a unique opportunity for the Philippines to leverage its large, tech-savvy, English-speaking workforce as a competitive asset in the global AI supply chain.

Despite the country's recognized potential as a digital talent hub, many Filipinos—particularly those in vulnerable, low-income, or rural communities—lack access to structured digital skills training and employment pathways. There is an urgent need to institutionalize programs that bridge this gap, promote inclusive digital upskilling, and generate sustainable employment in the AI-driven economy.

A collaboration among the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA), Department of Education (DepEd), Aboitiz Foundation and Connected Women gave birth to Project AIDA (Artificial Intelligence and Data Annotation). A program that has proven that with the right skills and support, women, especially those in rural communities, can thrive in the global digital economy.

This bill seeks to institutionalize the Artificial Intelligence and Data Annotation (AIDA) Program as a national flagship initiative under the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA).

The proposed measure aims to position the Philippines as a global center for ethical and inclusive AI workforce development by:

1. Establishing AI and data annotation training curricula and certification programs across TESDA training centers, schools, and accredited institutions;
2. Creating digital employment pathways for underemployed youth, women, persons with disabilities (PWDs), displaced workers, and other marginalized sectors;
3. Fostering public-private partnerships with local and international tech companies to ensure industry-aligned standards and job placements;

4. Promoting ethical and responsible practices in data handling, privacy, and labor conditions in digital work; and
5. Allocating sufficient resources for program development, infrastructure, connectivity, equipment, and trainer capacity-building.

By institutionalizing Project AIDA, the government affirms its commitment to preparing the Filipino workforce for the jobs of the future while promoting digital equity and economic inclusion. It also supports the broader goals of national innovation, digital transformation, and resilience in a technology-driven global economy.

It shall be commonly known as TESDA BaVae, in recognition of the hard work and excellence of virtual assistants who are mostly women.

Through this legislative measure, we can invest in the digital future of women. We, as a nation, are not just teaching them new skills... We are uplifting families, transforming communities, and strengthening our economy.

In view of the foregoing, the passage of this measure is earnestly sought.



HON. FLORABEL CO YATCO

Representative

Nanay Partylist

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
H.B. No. 5912

Introduced by Hon. Florabel Co Yatco

AN ACT INSTITUTIONALIZING THE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND DATA ANNOTATION (Project AIDA) AS A NATIONAL DIGITAL UPSKILLING AND EMPLOYMENT PROGRAM UNDER THE TECHNICAL EDUCATION AND SKILLS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (TESDA), PROVIDING FUNDS THEREFOR, AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the Philippines in Congress assembled:

SECTION 1. Short Title.- This Act shall be known as the “TESDA BaVA-e Act”.

SECTION 2. Declaration of Policy.- It is the policy of the State to promote women empowerment and provide equal access to employment, education, and technological advancement. Further, the government shall support the development and institutionalization of programs that equip women, particularly housewives and mothers, with digital and remote work skills.

SECTION 3. Objectives. - The proposed measure aims to position the Philippines as a global center for ethical and inclusive AI workforce development by:

1. Establishing AI and data annotation training curricula and certification programs across TESDA training centers, schools, and accredited institutions;
2. Creating digital employment pathways for underemployed youth, women, persons with disabilities (PWDs), displaced workers, and other marginalized sectors;
3. Fostering public-private partnerships with local and international tech companies to ensure industry-aligned standards and job placements;
4. Promoting ethical and responsible practices in data handling, privacy, and labor conditions in digital work; and
5. Allocating sufficient resources for program development, infrastructure, connectivity, equipment, and trainer capacity-building.

SECTION 4. Institutionalization of the Project AIDA.- The Artificial Intelligence and Data Annotation (Project AIDA) shall be institutionalized as a national upskilling and employment program under the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA). The program shall be commonly known as “TESDA BaVAe” in recognition of the role of women in nation-building and contribution to our country’s digital economy. The program shall form part of TESDA’s regular and continuing digital skills training offerings.

SECTION 5. Components of TESDA BaVAe Program.- This program shall include, but not be limited to, the following areas of competency:

- a) Digital literacy and remote work fundamentals;

- b) Virtual assistance and administrative support;
- c) Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Data Annotation skills;
- d) Basic business English and communication; and
- e) Work readiness and ethics in virtual environments.

SECTION 6. Priority Beneficiaries.- In coordination with the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD), local government units (LGUs) and their respective public employment services office (PESO), TESDA shall evaluate and assess the beneficiaries who shall be:

- a) Women, particularly housewives and stay-at-home mothers;
- b) Individuals in geographically isolated and disadvantaged areas (GIDAs);
- c) Displaced workers and career shifters; and
- d) Persons from low-income and underserved communities.

SECTION 7. Curriculum and Qualification Framework of BaVAe Program.- TESDA, in consultation with the academes, Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT), Connected Women, and other relevant stakeholders, shall develop and adopt the appropriate Training Regulations (TRs), program packages, or short-course modules for Project AIDA, consistent with the Philippine National Qualifications Framework (PNQF) and the needs of the digital workforce.

SECTION 8. Implementation and Partnerships.- TESDA shall implement TESDA BaVAe through its Regional and Provincial Training Centers, TESDA-administered Technology Institutions (TTIs), and accredited private institutions. It may enter into partnerships with public and private entities to support the program's sustainability and expansion.

SECTION 9. Scholarship and Support Services.- TESDA shall allocate slots for TESDA BaVAe Program under its existing scholarship programs, including but not limited to:

- a) Training for Work Scholarship Program (TWSP);
- b) Special Training for Employment Program (STEP); and
- c) Tulong Trabaho Fund under Republic Act No. 11230.

TESDA shall also coordinate with government agencies and private partners to provide support such as devices, connectivity subsidies, job placement and other relevant assistance.

SECTION 10. Appropriations.- The amount needed for the implementation of this Act shall be charged to the current year's appropriations of the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA). Thereafter, such amount as may be necessary for the continued implementation of this Act shall be included in the annual General Appropriations Act.

SECTION 11. Implementing Rules and Regulations.- Within sixty (60) days from the effectivity of this Act, TESDA, in coordination with the Philippine Commission on Women (PCW), Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT), Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD), other relevant agencies and stakeholders, shall promulgate the implementing rules and regulations (IRR) necessary for the effective implementation of this Act.

SECTION 12. Separability Clause.- If any provision of this Act is declared invalid or unconstitutional, the other provisions not affected thereby shall remain valid and subsisting.

SECTION 13. Repealing Clause.- All laws, decrees, executive orders, rules and regulations, and other issuances or parts thereof inconsistent with or contrary to the provisions of this Act are repealed, amended, or modified accordingly.

SECTION 14. Effectivity Clause.- This Act shall take effect fifteen (15) days after its publication in the Official Gazette or in a newspaper of general circulation in the Philippines.

Approved,